

Humana — Internal Pre-Meeting Prep

Account owner: Kyle Hix · **Prepared:** Oct 5, 2026 · **Fit score:** 77/100 (active prospect) · **Full brief:** next pages

Purpose of this meeting: agree on how we enter Humana, who we contact first, and what each of us owns. Medicare Annual Enrollment opens **Oct 15**, so the outreach window is now.

The account in 60 seconds

- **Scale:** 20,000+ member advocates handle up to **~80M member calls a year**. One of the largest inbound voice operations in U.S. healthcare.
- **Incumbent:** **Google Cloud** (Vertex AI / Gemini) powers *Agent Assist*, a copilot for human advocates, rolling out across member service centers through 2026. Humana claims \$100M+ in savings over a few years.
- **Gap:** No public evidence of AI that resolves calls on its own. Routine calls still reach a person. Reviews cite 30–45-minute holds.
- **Mandate:** On the Q2 call, the CEO said Humana wants to be "simpler, leaner and faster" and to lead with "automation and AI with best-performing vendors."
- **Timing:** Enrollment peak (Oct 15 – Dec 7) plus ~600K members getting plan-exit letters. A new CTO (Apr 2026) and CDO (Jul 2025) are both in their first year.

Decisions we need today

#	Decision	Options	Kyle's recommendation
1	Lead motion	(a) Direct: Voice Agent API for self-service, bake-off vs. Google speech · (b) Co-sell through their CCaaS partner	(a) now , switch to (b) if discovery shows Five9 / Amazon Connect / Twilio / Genesys
2	First door	CDO Damian Warren (digital and self-service) · CTO Bobby Mukundan (technical) · both	Both in parallel. Warren on the business case, Mukundan on the bake-off
3	Bake-off offer	Size, scope, and data handling	~500 real member calls; accuracy on member IDs, drug names, senior voices; latency; cost per hour; run in their VPC
4	Timing	Before Oct 15 vs. after the enrollment peak (Dec 7)	Before Oct 15 for the first touch, framed as "for your January / next enrollment period." Expect meetings to land in December or January
5	Exec involvement	Deepgram exec to CTO-level outreach?	Yes. Peer note to Mukundan (ex-CVS CIO, ex-JPMorgan CTO)

Who does what (assign owners)

Workstream	Owner	Due
Outreach to Damian Warren (CDO) + business-case email	Kyle Hix	Before Oct 15
Technical note + bake-off proposal for Bobby Mukundan (CTO)	Sales Engineer: _____	Before Oct 15
Ask Five9 / AWS / Twilio / Genesys partner teams whether Humana is their customer	Partner manager: _____	This week
Check our own CRM and console for existing humana.com sign-ups, usage, or past opportunities	_____	This week

Workstream	Owner	Due
Healthcare security pack (HIPAA BAA, VPC / on-prem, PHI handling) ready for procurement	_____	Before first meeting
Exec-to-exec note to CTO	Exec sponsor: _____	After partner check
Find the VP / Director of Member Services (contact center leader)	Kyle Hix / BDR: _____	This week

What we still don't know (and how we'll find out)

Unknown	Why it matters	How to find out
CCaaS / telephony platform	Decides direct vs. co-sell	Partner teams; job posts; ask in discovery
Speech engine under the IVR	Displacement target (Google? Nuance?)	Discovery Q4; SE network
BPO vendors for member calls	Savings case and timing of contract renewals	Discovery Q7; 10-K
Contact center leader's name	Champion with the most enrollment-season pain	Web search; LinkedIn via network
Any existing Deepgram footprint	Expansion vs. new logo	Internal CRM and console check

Risks to discuss

- **Google is entrenched.** It shipped a visible win and claims \$100M+ in savings, and may bundle Gemini virtual agents next. *Counter:* compete on measured accuracy, latency, and cost on their audio. Bring your own LLM, so they can keep Gemini as the brain.
- **Peak-season freeze.** Operations and IT may not take meetings from Oct 15 to Dec 7. *Counter:* aim the first touch at the 2027 roadmap and land meetings in December or January.
- **Vendor consolidation.** Humana is reducing vendors. *Counter:* position as replacing IVR speech and BPO spend, or deliver through a partner they already pay.
- **Compliance.** CMS marketing rules, HIPAA, and a senior population. *Counter:* VPC / on-prem deployment; start with low-risk informational intents.
- **Evidence quality.** Several facts in the brief come from search-result excerpts. Verify the linked sources before quoting them to Humana.

Proposed first customer meeting (30 min)

1. **Intros and purpose** (3 min)
2. **Their priorities:** 2027 self-service roadmap, enrollment-season results (7 min)
3. **Discovery:** top routine intents; speech engine under the IVR; authentication failure rate (10 min)
4. **Proof:** Five9 healthcare result (authentication rates doubled) plus a short live voice-agent demo (6 min)
5. **Next step:** agree on bake-off scope and a data-handling path (4 min)

Asks of the team

- Bring any Humana or health-plan relationships you have (former colleagues, partner contacts).
- SE: confirm we can run the bake-off in a Humana VPC and how long it takes to stand up.
- Marketing: do we have a payer / health-plan reference we can name?

Humana — Deepgram Account Brief

Generated 2026-10-05 · Depth: quick · Fit score: 77/100 (active prospect, close to "pursue now")

Legend: plain text = sourced fact [n] · **HYPOTHESIS** = inference, verify on the call · **Unknown** = not found; see discovery questions
Run note: The free collectors (website / EDGAR / job boards) were blocked by this session's network policy. All facts come from web-search results, and several come from search-result excerpts rather than full-page reads. Click through to verify anything before quoting it to a customer.

TL;DR

- **Who they are:** Humana (NYSE: HUM), a major Medicare Advantage insurer. 20,000+ call-center "member advocates" handle up to **~80M member calls a year** [2].
- **Why now:** Medicare **Annual Enrollment opens Oct 15**, and ~600,000 MA members just got letters saying their plan ends in 2027 [4]. The CEO says Humana wants to be "simpler, leaner, faster" and to lead with "automation and AI with best-performing vendors" [6][7].
- **#1 pain hypothesis:** **HYPOTHESIS** Humana has invested in helping human agents (Google Cloud Agent Assist) [1][2] but not in automating calls end to end. Every routine call still reaches a person, and members publicly report 30–45-minute holds [12].
- **Motion: Displacement + new use case.** Google Cloud owns AI that assists agents [1]. Deepgram's opening is the voice self-service layer in front of the advocates (Voice Agent API), proven on accuracy with health-plan IDs. If discovery shows Humana runs Five9, Amazon Connect, Twilio, or Genesys, switch to **co-sell through that partner**.
- **People to win: Bobby Mukundan**, SVP & CTO (new, April 2026, ex-CVS/JPMorgan) [8], and **Damian Warren**, SVP & Chief Digital Officer (July 2025, ex-U.S. Bank digital channels) [9]. Both are new leaders in their first year. They are probably building their roadmaps now.
- **Ask this one question:** "Agent Assist makes each of your 80M calls better. What's your plan for the calls that shouldn't need an advocate at all?"

1. Snapshot

Industry / HQ	Health insurance (Medicare Advantage, Medicaid, Part D) plus CenterWell care delivery and pharmacy; Louisville, KY
Public / private	Public, NYSE: HUM [15]
Membership	Added ~1M individual MA members in the 2026 enrollment period [13]
Contact center scale	20,000+ member advocates, up to ~80M member calls/year [2]
Inbound volume indicators	Separate member lines per product and state (MA, Medicaid by state, CenterWell Pharmacy). Seasonal peak during AEP (Oct 15 – Dec 7)

2. Strategy & Priorities

- CEO **Jim Rehtin** (Q2 2026 call, Aug 2026) set three operating goals: be "**simpler, leaner and faster**" while reducing friction for customers; **lead on innovation by leveraging automation and AI with best-performing vendors**; and attract top talent [6][7].
- Simplification is framed as lowering operating cost *and* improving service quality [6].
- Humana expects **\$100M+ in savings over a few years** from Agent Assist alone [1][3]. AI in the call center is already a proven savings lever with leadership.

3. Financial Health & Budget Signals

- Consolidated operating cost ratio **down 120 bps year over year**, driven by centralization and **outsourcing** [7].

- Increasing outsourcing in finance and HR while **reducing the number of vendors** [14]. **HYPOTHESIS** procurement will favor platforms over point tools.
- Reaffirmed FY2026 guidance in September 2026 [15]. Exiting lower-performing MA plans to protect margin [4].

4. Trigger Events

Date	Event	Why it matters for Voice AI
Oct 15 – Dec 7, 2026	Medicare Annual Enrollment Period	Biggest call spike of the year, so elastic AI capacity has a clear deadline
Sept 2026	~600K MA members notified their plans end in 2027 [4]	A surge of "what happens to my plan?" calls: repetitive, high-intent, good for automation
Sept 2026	Part D president TJ Gibb left via a voluntary early-retirement program [5]	Leadership turnover and an early-retirement program. HYPOTHESIS Fewer staff available for peak season
Aug 2026	Q2 call: "automation and AI with best-performing vendors" [6]	Explicit executive mandate to buy AI from vendors
Apr 2026	Bobby Mukundan named SVP & CTO (newly elevated role) [8]	New technical leader in his first 6–12 months
Oct 2025 → 2026	Agent Assist (Google Cloud) rolling out to all member service centers [1][3]	The contact center is being modernized now. Self-service is the logical next step
Jul 2025	Damian Warren named Chief Digital Officer [9]	Owns digital/self-service channels

5. Contact Center & CX Operations

- **Scale:** 20,000+ advocates, ~80M calls/year [2].
- **Model:** Agent Assist is designed as **human-in-the-loop**. AI supports advocates and does not resolve calls on its own [1] [2].
- **Known pain:** Reviews on Trustpilot, ConsumerAffairs, and BBB cite long holds (30–45 min), repeat calls, dropped calls, and unresolved billing and policy questions [12].
- **Sourcing:** "Outsourcing" is cited as a cost lever [7]. Which BPO vendors handle member calls (if any) is **Unknown**.
- **Seasonal peaks:** AEP (Oct–Dec), January plan start (ID cards, pharmacy, "is my doctor covered?").

6. Tech Stack & Incumbents

Layer	Vendor	Evidence	Implication
CRM	Salesforce (Health Cloud)	Multi-year agreement announced Sept 2020 STALE [11]	Pre-built Salesforce integration is a strong fit. Confirm whether Service Cloud runs member services
CCaaS / telephony	Unknown	n/a	Discovery question #2
Conversational AI	Google Cloud (Vertex AI / Gemini) for Agent Assist [1] [2]	Agent-facing copilot	Competitive risk: Google will pitch CCAI virtual agents next. Position as the best-of-breed voice front door that works alongside Agent Assist
IVR	Unknown	n/a	HYPOTHESIS Probably a legacy press-1 IVR in front of 80M calls
Speech engine (STT/TTS)	Unknown for IVR. Agent Assist runs on Google (Vertex AI / Gemini) [1][2]	n/a	HYPOTHESIS Google speech probably sits under Agent Assist, which makes Google the direct Deepgram competitor . No evidence of existing Deepgram use

Layer	Vendor	Evidence	Implication
Agent guidance / analytics	Balto (vendor's own claim that it serves Humana member services) [17]	Vendor blog	Find Balto's speech engine. It could be a Deepgram embed opportunity
BPO	Unknown	"outsourcing" cited [7]	AI-handled calls could offset BPO spend

7. Hiring Signals

Unknown. The job-board collector was blocked in this session. Rerun locally, or search for "Humana member advocate jobs" and "Humana conversational AI jobs". Look for: advocate requisition volume before AEP, Genesys/NICE/Amazon Connect engineers (which would reveal the CCaaS platform), and conversational AI / IVR roles (build vs. buy).

8. Buying Committee

Persona	Name	Title	Background	Likely role	Source
Executive / CX sponsor	David Dintenfass	President, Enterprise Growth (since Feb 2024)	Former Fidelity CMO and Head of Customer Experience Design. Owns acquisition, retention, and experience	Economic buyer / exec sponsor	[10]
CIO	Japan A. Mehta	Chief Information Officer (since Feb 2025)	Owns IT, infrastructure, cyber, digital & AI , and the transformation vision	Approver; owns AI vendor strategy	[10]
CTO	Bobby Mukundan	SVP & CTO (Apr 2026)	Ex-Accenture MD; ex-CVS Health SVP & CIO; ex-JPMorgan global CTO	Technical approver	[8]
Digital / product	Damian Warren	SVP & Chief Digital Officer (Jul 2025)	Ex-U.S. Bank head of consumer digital channels experience	Likely champion for self-service	[9]
Contact center leader	Unknown	VP/Director Member Services / Consumer Operations	n/a	Champion and user	Find via web search or ask Warren's team

Note: Former CTO Eric Tagliere left to become CIO at R1 (June 2026) [16]. **HYPOTHESIS** That turnover could open the door to a new vendor.

9. People You're Meeting

No attendees given. Rerun with --attendees before a meeting.

10. Competitive Landscape

- **Market peers:** UnitedHealthcare, CVS/Aetna, Elevance, Centene, and Cigna are all under the same MA margin pressure. **HYPOTHESIS** Peer AI-service moves give you a fear-of-falling-behind angle (research in deep mode).
- **Deepgram competitors in the account: Google Cloud** (incumbent for AI in the contact center; Gemini/Vertex) [1]. Possible: Nuance/Microsoft (common legacy healthcare IVR speech). **Unknown.**
- **Deepgram partners in the account: Unknown.** The CCaaS platform is discovery question #2. If it's Five9, Amazon Connect, Twilio, or Genesys, bring in that partner's Humana account team.

11. Pain → Solution Map

Observed signal	HYPOTHESIS Pain hypothesis	Our value prop	Proof point
80M calls; AI only assists humans [1][2]	Every routine call (ID card, claim status, pharmacy refill, plan/doctor lookup) uses advocate minutes	Voice Agent API: end-to-end resolution of top intents	Five9 healthcare provider doubled authentication rates with Deepgram; 2–4x more accurate on alphanumerics [18]
Member IDs, Rx names, Medicare numbers spoken by seniors	HYPOTHESIS Speech errors on IDs force callers to agents	Accuracy on alphanumerics and accents , plus custom models	Same Five9 story [18]
30–45 min holds in reviews [12]	Members abandon calls, call back, and complain. Hurts Star ratings and CAHPS	Instant answer, 24/7	
AEP + 600K plan exits [4]	October–December spike exceeds staffing	Elastic capacity for peak intents	
"Leaner, faster... AI with best-performing vendors" [6]	Board-level cost mandate, and a preference to buy over build	Lower cost to serve , fast time to value	
Salesforce relationship [11]	Integration risk is a CIO/CTO concern	Voice agent calls Salesforce through function calling; context passed into Agent Assist on handoff	
HIPAA / CMS marketing rules	Compliance blocks AI pilots	VPC / on-prem deployment , so audio stays in Humana's environment	Elerian AI (on-prem, banking) [19]
80M calls on hyperscaler speech	HYPOTHESIS Speech cost at this scale is material	Lower cost per hour at volume	Wistia: 3–5x lower cost than alternatives [20]

12. ROI Sketch

$\text{annual_calls} \times \text{automatable_share} \times \text{containment} \times (\text{human} - \text{AI cost per call})$ - Annual calls: **80M** (sourced [2]) - Automatable share: 30–50% (assumed) - Containment: 50–70% (assumed) - Human cost/call: \$4–\$8 (assumed); AI cost/call: \$0.50–\$1.50 (assumed)

Conservative: $80\text{M} \times 30\% \times 50\% \times \$3 \approx \$36\text{M/yr}$. **Midpoint:** $80\text{M} \times 40\% \times 60\% \times \$5 \approx \$96\text{M/yr}$. Over three years, even the conservative case (~\$108M) matches Humana's entire Agent Assist savings target (\$100M+ over a few years) [1]. That gives you a frame their leadership has already approved.

13. Talk Track

- **Opener:** "Jim Rehtin told investors Humana wants to be leaner and faster by leading with AI from best-performing vendors. You've already shown that with Agent Assist across 80 million calls. Deepgram helps health plans take the next step: voice agents that resolve routine calls before they reach an advocate. One healthcare provider doubled its caller authentication rate when it switched its speech engine to Deepgram."
- **Value angles:**
- **CTO / CIO (Mukundan, Mehta):** Bake-off on Humana's own call audio (member IDs, drug names, senior voices) against Google speech. Runs in Humana's VPC. Works alongside Agent Assist and Salesforce, with no rip-and-replace.
- **Engineering lead:** Voice Agent API with bring-your-own LLM. They can even keep Gemini as the brain and use Deepgram for real-time speech.
- **CDO (Warren):** Voice becomes a digital channel. Same intents and analytics as web/app self-service.

- *Contact center leader:* AEP and January peak coverage. Advocates get the complex, high-value calls.
- **Customer story:** Five9 healthcare deployment: authentication rates doubled after switching to Deepgram [18]. Abby Connect launched an AI receptionist handling 100K+ calls a month [21].

14. Discovery Questions (ranked)

1. What share of the ~80M calls are routine intents (ID cards, claim status, pharmacy, provider lookup, plan changes), and how are they handled today?
2. Which IVR and CCaaS platform sits in front of the advocates? When is that contract up?
3. Is self-service voice automation on the 2027 roadmap? Is it owned by Digital (Warren), IT (Mehta/Mukundan), or Operations?
4. Is Google Cloud being evaluated for virtual agents, or is the plan best of breed? Which speech engine runs under today's IVR and Agent Assist?
5. Would they run a bake-off on a sample of real member calls (accuracy on IDs and drug names, latency, cost per hour)?
6. How did hold times and abandonment look during last year's AEP? What's the target this year?
7. What share of member calls go to BPO partners, and what is the cost per call there?
8. What are the compliance gates (CMS marketing rules, HIPAA) for an AI agent talking to members?

15. Likely Objections & Responses

Objection	Response
"We already have AI — Agent Assist with Google."	Agent Assist makes human calls better. Deepgram voice agents remove calls that don't need a human. The two work together. Offer a bake-off on Humana audio vs. Google speech.
"We're standardized on Google."	Keep Gemini as the LLM if they want. The Voice Agent API is bring-your-own-LLM. Compete on speech accuracy, latency, and cost, measured on their own calls.
"Seniors won't talk to a bot."	Natural speech is easier than press-1 menus. Offer an instant zero-out to an advocate. Measure CSAT on AI-handled calls in the pilot.
"CMS / HIPAA risk."	VPC or on-prem deployment so audio never leaves Humana; start with low-risk informational intents.
"We're consolidating vendors."	Land alongside existing Salesforce and CCaaS investments. Show that we replace IVR and BPO spend, not add a line item.

16. Relationship History

No prior email contact found in Gmail with `humana.com` addresses.

17. Next Best Actions

1. **Before Oct 15:** Send Damian Warren (CDO) a short email built on the AEP and plan-exit call surge, plus the Agent Assist "next step" angle. Ask for 20 minutes with his self-service lead.
2. In parallel, send Bobby Mukundan (CTO) a technical note offering a **speech bake-off on 500 real member calls** vs. their current engine, with VPC deployment and the Five9 healthcare authentication result.
3. Find the VP of Member Services / Consumer Operations through web search and through your network. That person feels the AEP pain most.
4. Ask Deepgram partner teams (Five9, AWS, Twilio, Genesys) whether Humana is their customer. That's the fastest way to learn the CCaaS platform and find a co-sell path.
5. Rerun `/account-brief humana.com --deep` once you have a meeting, to fill in the Unknowns (CCaaS, BPO, hiring).

Fit Score Breakdown

Dimension	Score	Why
Inbound volume	30/30	~80M calls/year, 20K+ advocates [2]
Pain evidence	22/25	Public hold-time complaints [12]; cost mandate [6]
Timing / triggers	18/20	AEP, 600K plan exits, new CTO and CDO, explicit AI-vendor language
Stack compatibility	10/15	Salesforce relationship STALE ; CCaaS unknown
Access	2/10	No prior relationship
Competitor adjustment	-5	Google Cloud is a direct speech competitor and incumbent for agent assist. Kept small because it's assist only, not containment, and the speech engine is unconfirmed
Total	77/100	Active prospect, close to "pursue now"

Sources

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